



Visarpa

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To learn the concept of Visarpa
- ⇒ To learn the Nidana and Samprapti of Visarpa in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease
- ⇒ To enlist the types of Visarpa
- ⇒ To learn the Purvarupa of Visarpa
- ⇒ To know the features of Bahya and Abhyantara Visarpa
- ⇒ To learn Sadhyasadyata of Visarpa
- ⇒ To differentiate Doshaja Visarpa
- ⇒ To learn Agni, Kardama and Granthi Visarpa

Introduction



Figure 122: Pratyatma Lakshana of Visarpa

Visarpa is a spectrum of diseases where there will be rapid vitiation of *Dosha* involving *Tvak* (skin). It involves *Tridosha*, *Tvak*, *Rakta*, *Mamsa* and *Lasika*. These seven factors are considered as *Saptaka Dravya Sangraha*¹. This is considered to be *Ashukari* (fast spreading and fast progressing) *Vikara*. Though the disease is considered

to be manifested due to the vitiation of all three *Dosha*, *Pitta Dosha* is the primary *Dosha* responsible for the manifestation of the disease. As far as the classification of diseases as per *Sushruta*, this disease is categorised under *Amashayasamuttha* and *Sharirika* varieties of *Doshabala Pravritta Vikara* of *Adhyatmika Vikara*. Based on the above context, *Amashaya* is considered as *Udbhava Sthana* of the disease, *Sarvasharira* is considered as *Sanchara Sthana* and *Tvak* is *Vyakta Sthana* of the disease. *Rakvataha Srotas* is afflicted during the progression of the disease with *Sanga* and *Vimargagamana* as the type of *Srotodushti* involved during the progression. In the following pages, we are going to analyse the concept of *Visarpa* elaborately.

Pratyatma Lakshana of Visarpa

विविधं सर्पति यतो विसर्पस्तेन स स्मृतः।

परिसर्पोऽथवा नाम्ना सर्वतः परिसर्पणात्॥१॥

Ca.Ci. - 21/11

The cardinal feature of the disease *Visarpa* is fast or rapid spreading nature in different directions in the skin. As the spread of the disease in different directions, this is also termed as *Parisarpa*.

G
K

1 As per Ayurveda, two diseases are having *Saptaka Dravya Sangraha* – *Kushtha* and *Visarpa*. The difference between *Kushtha* and *Visarpa* is *Kushtha* is a *Chirakari Vikara* (slowly progressing), whereas *Visarpa* is a *Ashukari* (fast progressive) *Vikara*. *Kushtha* is a disease manifested due to the vitiation of *Tridosha*, whereas *Visarpa* is *Pitta* dominant disease, but *Rakta Dhatu* is mainly afflicted during the progression of the disease.

Nidana of Visarpa

लवणाम्लकटूष्णानां रसानामति सेवनात्।
 दध्यम्लमस्तुक्तानां सुरासौवीरकस्य च॥16॥
 व्यापन्नबहुमद्योष्णरागपाडवसेवनात्।
 शाकानां हरितानां च सेवनाच्च विदाहिनाम्॥17॥
 कूर्चिकानां किलाटानां सेवनान्मन्दकस्य च।
 दक्षः शाण्डाकि पूर्वाणामासुतानां च सेवनात्॥18॥
 तिलमापकुलत्थानां तैलानां पैष्टिकस्य च।
 ग्राम्यानूपीदकानां च मांसानां लशुनस्य च॥159॥
 प्रक्लिन्नानामसात्यानां विरुद्धानां च सेवनात्।
 अत्यादानाद्दिवास्वप्नादजीर्णाध्यशनात् क्षतात्॥20॥
 क्षेतबन्धप्रपतनाद्धर्मकर्मतिसेवनात्।
 विषवाताग्निदोषाश्च विसर्पाणां समुद्भवः॥21॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/16-21

- ❖ Excess consumption of *Lavana* (salt), *Amla* (sour), *Katu* (pungent) *Rasa* substances²

- ❖ Excess consumption of *Ushna* (hot in potency) substances³
- ❖ Excess consumption of *Dadhi* (curds) and other intoxicating substances⁴
- ❖ Excess consumption of improperly prepared wine and other intoxicating substances⁵
- ❖ Excess consumption of green leafy vegetables⁶
- ❖ Excess consumption of substances which lead to burning sensation in the body⁷
- ❖ Excess consumption of curds and preparations made by curds⁸
- ❖ Consumption of sesamum seeds, blackgram items, horse gram items, oily items, flour⁹
- ❖ Consumption of meat of domestic, marshy animals and aquatic animals¹⁰
- ❖ Consumption of garlic¹¹

- 2 Lavana, Amla and Katu Rasa substances are having Tejo Mahabhuta predominance in them. Excess consumption of these substances are likely to increase the Pitta Dosha abnormally.
- When an individual continuously consuming these Rasa substances, that will lead to inflammation of gastric mucosa, poor functioning of digestive juices (more fluid entry into stomach because of excess presence of inflammatory markers which are nothing but proteins, poor functioning of hydrochloric acid, poor conversion of pepsinogen into pepsin).
 - Nutrient depletion inside the body (sequential depletion of carbohydrates, fats and proteins) leading to ketoacidosis and lactic acidosis.
 - This will lead to lowered immune status. Thus, this aetiology is not directly responsible for the manifestation of Visarpa, this becomes an indirect aetiological factor for Visarpa manifestation.
- 3 Excess consumption of Ushna Virya substances refers to excess consumption of green chilli or red chilli or substances having masala items. This is responsible for the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta in the body. Thus, this may lead to the abnormal increase of Pitta Dosha in the body. Refer the context of Lavana, Amla and Katu substances and their effect on the body for this context.
- 4 Excess consumption of Dadhi having Amla Rasa in particular or Dadhi which is prepared by adding green chilli, salt, asafoetida etc will be responsible for the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta and thus Pitta Dosha will be vitiated.
- Madya (alcoholic beverages) are having Amla Rasa, Ushna Virya and Amla Vipaka. If an individual is consuming these substances in excess, this may lead to the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta and thus there will be vitiation of Pitta Dosha.
- 5 Madya (alcoholic beverages) are having Amla Rasa, Ushna Virya and Amla Vipaka. If an individual is consuming these substances in excess, this may lead to the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta and thus there will be vitiation of Pitta Dosha.
- 6 This is a diagram of the anatomy of a plant with labels of structural parts of the plants and the roots. 1. Shoot system. 2. Root system. 3. Hypocotyl. 4. Terminal bud. 5. Leaf blade. 6. Internode. 7. Axillary bud. 8. Petiole. 9. Stem. 10. Node. 11. Tap root. 12. Root hairs. 13. Root tip. 14. Root cap
- The term Harita Shaka refers to stems of green leafy vegetables. When we speak of stems of plants, it contains xylems and phloems. The xylem will carry the water and nutrients from roots to upper part of the plant, wherein phloem will carry down food prepared by the leaf to different parts of the plants.
 - In monocots, the number of xylem and phloem is 8 and in dicots, the number is about 4.
 - When one consumes stems of green leafy vegetables, it may contain pathogens in the phloem, if an individual consumes these stems, may be at risk of development of disease. When an individual consumes, that may lead to inflammation of the stomach leading to inflammatory markers, which are proteins and leading to the pathological events as discussed earlier.
- 7 These substances are responsible for the increase of Tejo Mahabhuta in the body. When these substances consumed in excess, that may lead to vitiation of Pitta Dosha in the body.
- Excess consumption of these substances may lead to inflammation of the alimentary canal.
- 8 गुरुष्णस्निग्धमधुरा बलोपचयवर्धनाः। वृश्चाः परं वातहराः कफपित्तविवर्धनाः॥
 The qualities of meat of above said animals are Guru (heavy to digest), Ushna Virya (hot in potency), Snigdha (unctuous), responsible for the vitiation of Pitta and Kapha in the body. Meat in general lacks fibrous material, thus reducing the peristaltic movements of the alimentary canal. The contents mixed with meat may lead to the inflammation of the alimentary canal, thus, may lead to the abnormal increase of Pitta Dosha in the body. Ca.Su. – 27/56
- 9 क्रिमिकृच्छकिलासमो वातानो गुल्मनाशनः। निग्धोष्णश्च वृश्चश्च लशुनः कटुको गुरुः॥
 The qualities of Lashuna (garlic) are Snigdha (unctuous), Ushna Virya (hot in potency), Katu (pungent in taste), Guru (heavy to digest) are responsible for the increase of Pitta Dosha in the body. Ca.Su. – 27/176
- 10 If an individual is excessively indulging in these kinds of food intake, will lead to the inflammation of alimentary canal, which further leads to the poor absorption of nutrients from the body leading to sequential depletion of carbohydrates, fats and proteins. Thus, the person may have lowered immune status.
- 11 While analysing this etiological factor, we have to concentrate on two different aspects: Sleeping during day time and time of sleep i.e. after consumption of food in the noon time.

- Consumption of decomposed food substances¹²
- Consumption of unwholesome food substances¹³
- Consumption of incompatible food substances
- Consumption of more amount of food at a time
- Sleeping during day time
- Consumption of food substances prior to digestion of previously ingested meal
- Injury to the body
- Falling of the bandage of the wound
- Exposure to the toxic air, fire in excess

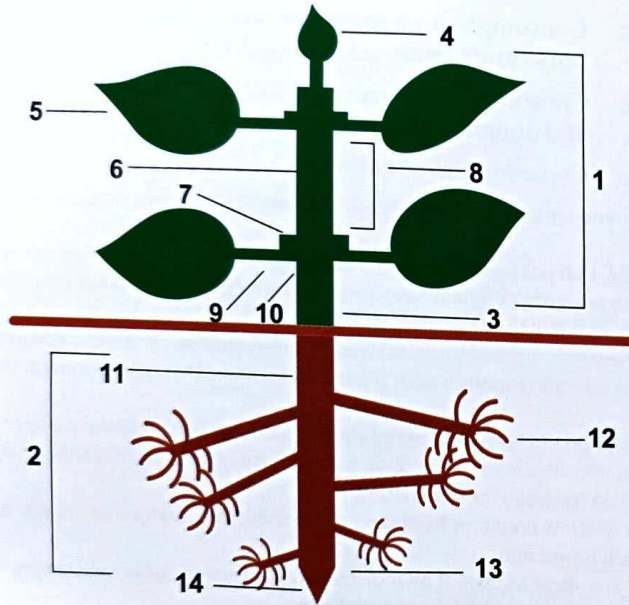


Figure 123: Harita Shaka

Samprapti of Visarpa

एतैर्निदानैर्व्यामिश्रैः कुपिता मारुतादयः।

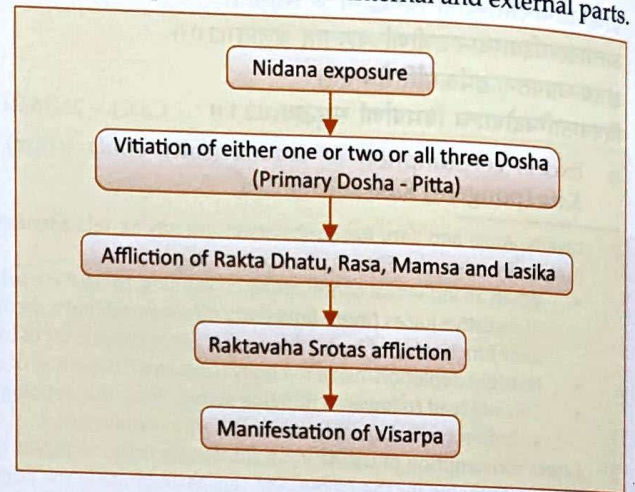
- Sleeping during day time, the person will have relaxation of most of the muscles of the body. This includes the relaxation of tone of airway dilator muscles results in collapse in the upper airways during sleep. Because of this mechanism, the person will have increased mouth breathing which results in snoring.
 - When an individual goes for sleep soon after the lunch, the body will have increased vascularity towards gastrointestinal compartment and there will be poor blood circulation to the nervous system and because of this reason, the person will have natural tendency of sleepiness during day time.
 - During sleep, there will parasympathetic nervous system stimulation, this will lead to the enhanced alimentary secretion and there will be poor muscular activity and this will cause poor digestion of food.
- 12 As food enters the stomach, it forms concentric circles of the food in the stomach, the newest food lying close to the oesophageal opening and oldest food lying nearest the outer wall of stomach. This leads to the stretching of the stomach. When there is beginning of the stretching of stomach, leads to the generation of vagovagal reflex from the stomach to the brainstem and then back to the stomach reduces the tone of muscle of the stomach. This leads to the outward bulge of the stomach, accommodating greater quantity of food. When stomach is completely relaxed, it accumulates 0.8 – 1.5 liters.
- Pylorus is usually open enough for water and other fluids to empty from the stomach to duodenum with ease. But when an individual consumes food, this leads to the closure of pyloric sphincter.
- As the person consumes food in the middle of meal times, there will be poor digestive fire also. The pH of gastric juice should be between 1.8 to 3.5. But after the consumption of frequent meals prior to the digestion of food in the stomach, increases the pH of gastric juice more than 3.5 moving towards alkalinity. In this state, pepsinogen will not be converted into active pepsin which converts the macromolecules into intermediate molecules. Thus, the person may have a state of indigestion in case of consumption of food between the meal times.
- 13 These aetiological factors are directly responsible for the contact of pathogens to the injured part of the body, thus increasing the risk of the development of infection.

दूष्यान् संदृष्ट्य रक्तादीन् विसर्पन्त्यहिताशिनाम्॥
बहिःश्रितः श्रितश्चान्तस्तथा चोभयसंश्रितः।
विसर्पो बलमेतेषां ज्ञेयं गुरु यथोत्तरम्॥23॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/22

Ca.Ci. – 21/23

- Vitiation of *Dosha* by consumption of above said one or more etiological factors
- Affliction of *Rakta* etc *Dhatu* takes place by these vitiated *Dosha*
- Manifestation of *Visarpa* takes place.
- Spread of the disease takes place to external parts, internal parts and to both internal and external parts.



Samprapti Ghataka

- **Dosha** : *Vata Pradhana Tridosha*
- **Dushya** : *Rakta*
- **Srotas** : *Raktavaha Srotas*
- **Srotodushti Prakara** : *Sanga and Vimargagamana*
- **Agni** : *Mandagni, Raktadhatvagnimandya*
- **Ama** : *Jatharagnijanya and Rakta Dhatvagninanya*

- ❖ Udbhava Sthana :
- ❖ Sanchara Sthana : *Sarva Sharira*
- ❖ Vyakta Sthana : *Tvak*
- ❖ Rogamarga : *Abhyantara and Bahya*
- ❖ Sadhyasadyata : *Krichrasadya to Asadya*
- ❖ Vyadhi Svabhava : *Ashukari*

Types of Visarpa

स च सप्तविधो दोषैर्विज्ञेयः सप्तधातुकः।
 पृथक् त्रयस्त्रिभिश्चैको विसर्पो द्वन्द्वास्त्रयः॥1 2॥
 वातिकः पैत्तिकश्चैव कफजः सान्निपातिकः।
 चत्वार एते विसर्पा वक्ष्यन्ते द्वन्द्वास्त्रयः॥1 3॥
 आग्नेयो वातपित्ताभ्यां ग्रन्थ्याख्यः कफवातजः।
 यस्तु कर्दमको घोरः स पित्तकफसंभवः॥1 4॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/12-14

Sankhya Samprapti: 7 types based on *Dosha* dominance

- ❖ *Vataja Visarpa*
- ❖ *Pittaja Visarpa*
- ❖ *Kaphaja Visarpa*
- ❖ *Vata Pittaja Visarpa – Agni Visarpa*
- ❖ *Vata Kaphaja Visarpa – Granthi Visarpa*
- ❖ *Pitta Kaphaja Visarpa – Kardama Visarpa*
- ❖ *Sannipataja Visarpa – Vata Pitta and Kapha Dosha dominance*

Vataja Visarpa

रूक्षोष्णैः केवलो वायुः पूरणैर्वा समावृतः।
 प्रदुष्टो दूषयन् दूष्यान् विसर्पति यथाबलम्॥2 9॥
 तस्य रूपाणि भ्रमदवथुपिपासा निस्तोदशूलाङ्ग- मदोद्वेष्टन
 कम्पज्वरतमकका सास्थिसंधिभेदविश्लेषणवेपनारोच-
 काविपाकाश्चक्षुषोराकुलत्वमस्त्रागमनं पिपीलिकासंचार
 इव चाङ्गेषु, यस्मिंश्चावकाशे विसर्पो विसर्पति सोऽवकाशः
 श्यावारुणाभासः श्रयथुमान् निस्तोदभेदशूलायामसंकोच-
 हर्षस्फुरणैरतिमात्रं प्रपीड्यते, अनुपक्रान्तश्चोपचीयते शीघ्र- भेदैः
 स्फोटकैस्तनुभिररुणाभैः श्यावैर्वा तनुविशदा- रुणाल्पास्त्रावैः,
 विबद्धवातमूत्रपुरीषश्च भवति, निदानोक्तानि चास्य नोपशेरते
 विपरीतानि चोप- शेरत इति वातविसर्पः॥3 0॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/29,30

- ❖ Consumption of *Ruksha* (dry) substances
- ❖ Consumption of *Ushna Virya* (hot in potency) substances
- ❖ *Vata* gets vitiated vitiating *Rakta* etc *Dushya*

Lakshana produced in Vataja Visarpa

- ❖ Giddiness
- ❖ Burning sensation
- ❖ Thirst
- ❖ Pricking type of pain

- ❖ Abdominal pain
- ❖ Body ache
- ❖ Muscle cramps
- ❖ Involuntary movements
- ❖ Raised body temperature
- ❖ Darkness in front of the eyes
- ❖ Cough
- ❖ Tearing type of pain in the bones and joints
- ❖ Looseness of the joints
- ❖ Trembling of the body parts
- ❖ Tastelessness
- ❖ Impaired digestion
- ❖ Congestion in the eyes
- ❖ Watering from the eyes
- ❖ Feeling as if ants crawling on the body (tingling sensation)
- ❖ Blackish or reddish discolouration of the affected part of the body with swelling
- ❖ Cutting, tearing type of pain, feeling of expansion, contraction, horripilation, and quivering of the skin.
- ❖ If not treated accordingly, it gives rise to rapid progression, small blackish or reddish skin eruptions with clear reddish and scanty discharge.
- ❖ The patient suffers from retention of flatus, faeces and urine.
- ❖ The etiological factors which is responsible for the vitiation of *Vata Dosha* will worsen and the factors which pacify *Vata Dosha* the *Lakshana* of *Vataja Visarpa*.

Pittaja Visarpa

पित्तमुष्णोपचारेण विदाह्यम्लाशनैश्चितम्।

दुष्यान् संदृष्य धमनीः पूरयन् वै विसर्पति॥3 1॥

तस्य रूपाणि-ज्वरस्तृष्णा मूर्च्छा मोहश्छर्दिर- रोकोऽङ्गभेदः स्वेदोऽति
 मात्र मन्तर्दाहः प्रलापः शिरोरुक् चक्षुषोराकुलत्वमस्त्रागमनं
 भ्रमः शीत- वातवारितर्षोऽतिमात्रं हरितहारिद्रनेत्रमूत्रवर्चस्त्वं
 हरितहारिद्ररूपदर्शनं च यस्मिंश्चावकाशे विसर्पो - नुसर्पति
 सोऽवकाशस्ताम्र हरितहारिद्रनीलकृष्णरतानां वर्णानामन्यतमं पुष्यति,
 सोत्सेधैश्चातिमात्रं दाहसंभेदनपरीतैः स्फोटकैरुपचीयते तुल्यवर्णास्त्रा-
 वैश्चिरपाकैश्च, निदानोक्तानि चास्य नोपशेरते विप- रीतानि चोपशेरत
 इति पित्तविसर्पः॥3 2॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/31,32

- ❖ Consumption of *Ushna Virya Ahara* (substances having hot potency)
- ❖ Consumption of food substances responsible for burning sensation in the epigastrium and thirst
- ❖ Excess consumption of *Amla* (sour) *Rasa* substances
- ❖ *Pitta* gets vitiated and responsible for the vitiation of *Rakta* etc leading to the manifestation of *Pitta* in the body

Lakshana of Pittaja Visarpa

- ⊗ Raised body temperature
- ⊗ Thirst
- ⊗ Altered state of consciousness
- ⊗ Confusion
- ⊗ Vomiting
- ⊗ Tastelessness
- ⊗ Body ache
- ⊗ Excess sweating
- ⊗ Burning sensation inside the body
- ⊗ Irrelevant and incomprehensible speech
- ⊗ Headache
- ⊗ Congestion of the eyes
- ⊗ Loss of sleep
- ⊗ Giddiness
- ⊗ Intense desire for cold air and water
- ⊗ Greenish or yellowish discolouration of eyes, urine and stool
- ⊗ Skin eruptions filled with greenish yellow, coppery coloured fluid or reddish coloured fluid
- ⊗ Skin eruption with severe burning sensation and tearing type of pain
- ⊗ Worsening of the *Lakshana* on consuming the *Nidana* of *Pittaja Visarpa* and improvement in the *Lakshana* on consuming the factors which pacify *Pitta Dosha*.

Kaphaja Visarpa¹⁴

स्वादुम्ललवणस्निग्धगुर्वन्नस्वप्नसंचितः।

कफः संदूषयन् दूष्यान् कृच्छ्रमङ्गे विसर्पति॥३३॥

तस्य रूपाणि - शीतकः शीतज्वरो गौरवं निद्रा तन्द्राऽरोचको मधुरास्यत्वमास्योपलेपो निष्ठीविका छर्दिरालस्यं स्तैमित्यमग्निनाशो दीर्बल्यं च, यस्मि - श्रावकाशे विसर्पोऽनुसर्पति सोऽवकाशः श्वयथु- मान् पाण्डुरातिरक्तः स्नेह सुप्तिस्तम्भगौरवैरन्वितोऽल्पवेदनः कृच्छ्रपाकैश्चिर-कारिभिर्बहुलत्वगुपलेपैः स्फोटैः श्वेतपाण्डुभिरनुबध्यते, प्रभिन्नस्तु श्वेतं पिच्छिलं तन्तुमद्धनमनुबद्धं स्निग्धमास्त्रावं स्रवति, ऊर्ध्वं च गुरुभिः स्थिरैर्जालवततैः स्निग्धैर्बहुल- वगुपले पर्वणैरनुबध्यतेऽनुषङ्गी च भवति, श्वेतन - खनयनवदनत्वड्युन्नवर्चस्त्वं, निदानोक्तानि चास्य नोपशेरते विपरीतानि चोपशेरत इति श्लेष्म- विसर्पः॥३४॥ Ca.Ci. - 21/33, 34

- ⊗ Excess consumption of *Svadu* (sweet) *Rasa*, *Amla* (sour) *Rasa* and *Lavana* (salt) *Rasa* substances
- ⊗ Excess consumption of *Snigdha* (unctuous) substances
- ⊗ Excess consumption of *Guru* (heavy to digest) substances

Lakshana of Kaphaja Visarpa

- ⊗ Feeling of coldness
- ⊗ Cold fever
- ⊗ Heaviness of the body parts
- ⊗ Excess sleep
- ⊗ Drowsiness
- ⊗ Tastelessness
- ⊗ Sweetish taste in the mouth
- ⊗ Coating over the tongue
- ⊗ Spitting the sputum
- ⊗ Vomiting
- ⊗ Laziness
- ⊗ Feeling of sensation of wet cloth covering the body
- ⊗ Loss of appetite
- ⊗ Weakness
- ⊗ Slowly progressing swelling associated with stiffness, heaviness, slow suppuration
- ⊗ When there is burst of the swelling, there will be whitish, yellowish white secretion with slimy thready, viscous and unctuous nature.
- ⊗ Whitish discolouration of nails, eyes, mouth, skin, urine and stool
- ⊗ Worsening of the *Lakshana* on exposure to *Kapha Dosha* etiological factors and improvement in the *Lakshana* on exposure to *Kapha* pacifying etiological factors.

Agni Visarpa¹⁵

वातपित्तं प्रकुपितमतिमात्रं स्वहेतुभिः।

परस्परं लब्धवलं दहदद्वात्रं विसर्पति॥३५॥

तदुपतापादातुरः सर्वशरीरमङ्गारैरिवाकीर्य- माणं मन्यते, छर्द्यतीसारमूर्च्छादाह मोहज्वरतमका- रोचका-स्थिसंधिभेदतृष्णाविपाकाङ्गभेदादिभिश्चा- भिभूयते, यं यं चावकाशं विसर्पोऽनुसर्पति सोऽवकाशः शान्ताङ्गारप्रकाशोऽतिरक्तो वा भवति, अग्निदग्धप्रकारैश्च

G
K

- 14 As far as Doshaja Visarpa is concerned, we have to know about the cardinal feature of the disease i.e. fast spreading nature of the disease. In case of Vata dominant Dosha, the clinical features observed are unpredictable in terms of discolouration, in terms of colour of discharge from the lesion or in terms of nature of spread in the body, the skin lesions observed may have dry skin lesions.
 - In case of Pitta dominant Visarpa, we may observe reddish discolouration of the skin lesion, associated with local rise of temperature or the presence of pus in the skin lesion etc.
 - In case of Kapha dominant Visarpa, the nature of spread will be very slow, the person may have secretions which may have lymph in it or whitish discolouration in the secretion.
- 15 In this condition, the person may have severe burning sensation associated with blisters. As already mentioned, this is associated with vitiation of dual Dosha, Vata and Pitta in the body. For example, when an individual is presented with herpes zoster, one of the major clinical presentation is severe burning sensation associated with blisters formation.



Figure 124: Lakshana of Agni Visarpa



Figure 125: Lakshana of Agni Visarpa

स्फोटैरुपचीयते स शीघ्रगत्वा- दावेव मर्मानुसारी भवति, मर्मणि चोपतप्ते पव- ५५ नित्यङ्गान्यतिमात्रं प्रमोहयति संज्ञां, हिक्काश्वासौ जनयति, नाशयति निद्रां स नष्टनिद्रः प्रमूढसंज्ञो व्यथितचेता न क्वचन सुखमुपलभते, अरतिपरीतः स्थानादासनाच्छय्यां क्रान्तुमिच्छति, क्लिष्टभूयिष्ठश्चाशु निद्रां भजति, दुर्बलो दुःखप्रबो- धश्च भवति तमेवंविधमग्निविसर्पपरीतमचिकित्स्यं विद्यात्॥३६॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/35,36

- ❖ The etiological factors which vitiate Vata and Pitta Dosha afflict the Rakta etc will lead to the manifestation of Agni Visarpa.
- ❖ The patient will have feeling of burning type of pain as if whole body is having contact with burning charcoal.
- ❖ Vomiting
- ❖ Burning sensation
- ❖ Raised body temperature
- ❖ Darkness in front of the eyes

- ❖ Tastelessness
- ❖ Tearing type of pain in bones and joints
- ❖ Thirst
- ❖ Impaired digestion
- ❖ Feeling of separation of body parts from the body
- ❖ The skin eruption will be similar to burn wounds
- ❖ Due to its fast spreading nature, it will reach Marma (vital point in the body) quickly
- ❖ Rogabala will be more than Rogibala, altered state of consciousness can be observed
- ❖ Breathlessness and hiccups
- ❖ Loss of sleep and mental confusion out of loss of sleep
- ❖ Restlessness
- ❖ In severe cases, the person can be aroused with difficulty due to weak physical strength, restlessness from standing to sitting and then falls in bed, being affected enormously he falls asleep instantaneously. In this state, Agni Visarpa is incurable.

Kardama Visarpa¹⁶

कफपित्तं प्रकुपितं बलवत् स्वेन हेतुना।

विसर्पत्येकदेशे तु प्रक्लेदयति देहिनम्॥३७॥

तद्विकाराः - शीतज्वरः शिरोगुरुत्वं दाहः स्तैमित्यमङ्गावसदनं निद्रा तन्त्रा मोहोऽन्नद्वेषः प्रलापोऽग्निनाशो दौर्बल्यमस्थिभेदो मूर्च्छा पिपासा स्रोतसां प्रलेपो जाड्यमिन्द्रियाणां प्रायोपवेशनमङ्गविक्षेपोऽङ्गमर्दोऽरतिरौत्सुक्यं चोपजायते, प्रायश्चामाशये विसर्पत्यलसक एकदेशग्राही च, यस्मिंश्चावकाशे विसर्पो विसर्पति सोऽवकाशो रक्तपीतपाण्डुपिडकावकीर्ण इव मेघकाभः कालो मलिनः स्निग्धो बहूष्मा गुरुः स्तिमितवेदनः श्वयथुमान् गम्भीरपाको निरास्त्रावः शीघ्रक्लेदः स्विन्न क्लिन्नपूतिमांसत्वक् क्रमेणाल्परुक् परामृष्टोऽवदीते कर्दम इवावपीडितोऽन्तरं प्रयच्छत्युपक्लिन्नपू- तिमांसत्यागी सिरास्नायुसंदर्शी कुणपगन्धी च भवति संज्ञास्मृतिहन्ता च तं कर्दमविसर्पपरीत- मचिकित्स्यं विद्यात्॥३८॥ Ca.Ci. – 21/37,38

- ❖ Etiological factors which vitiate Kapha and Pitta Dosha afflicting Rakta Dhatu etc will be responsible for the manifestation of Kardama Visarpa.
- ❖ Cold fever
- ❖ Heaviness of head
- ❖ Burning sensation
- ❖ Feeling of sensation of wet cloth covering the body
- ❖ Sluggish movements of body parts
- ❖ Sleep
- ❖ Drowsiness
- ❖ Confusion

16 This is associated with the vitiation of dual Dosha Kapha and Pitta Dosha in the body, particularly in Tvak region. The cardinal feature in this disease is foul smell in the body. This can be observed in wet gangrene or necrosis occurring in the body. Though this kind of pathological event can occur in any part of the body where cessation of blood flow is observed, the above said clinical feature is mainly seen in the lower limbs.

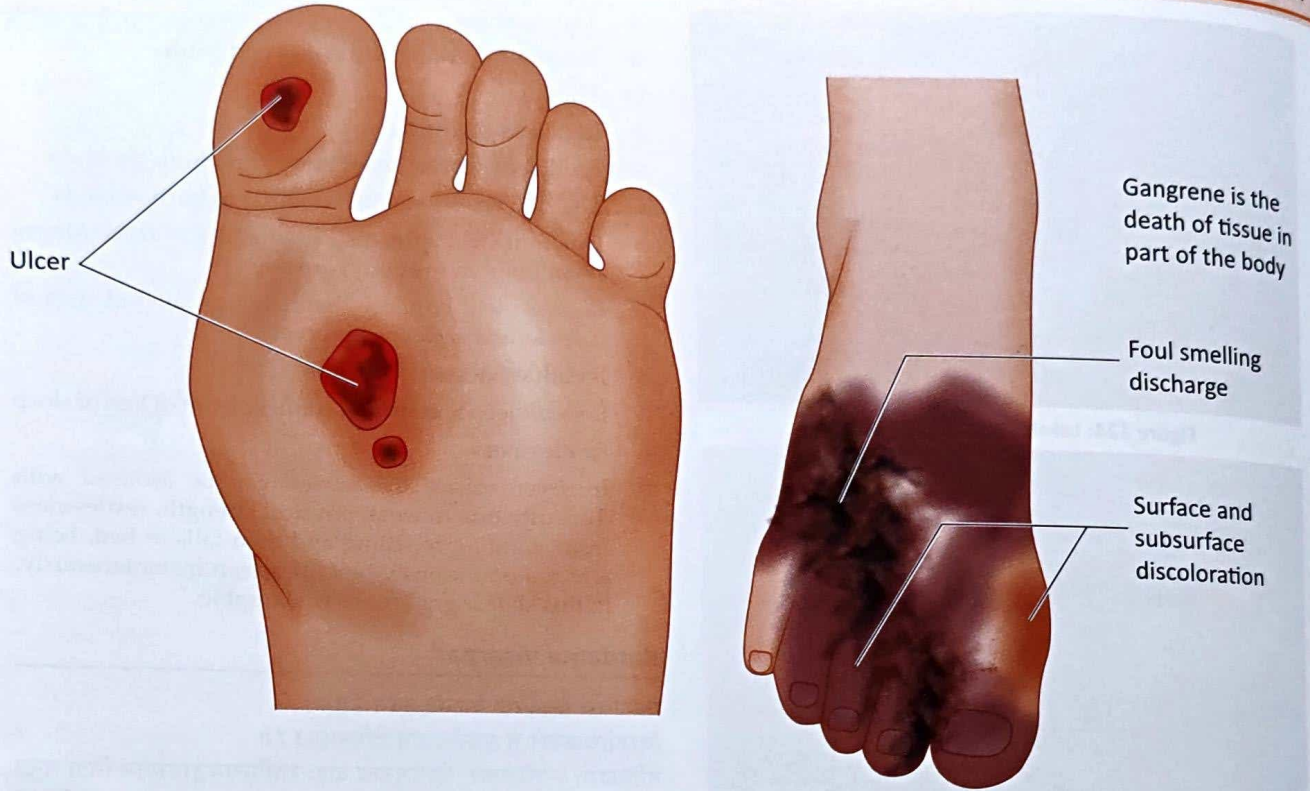


Figure 126: Lakshana of Kardama Visarpa

- ✿ Aversion to take food
- ✿ Irrelevant and incomprehensible speech
- ✿ Loss of appetite
- ✿ Weakness
- ✿ Tearing type of pain in bones
- ✿ Altered state of consciousness
- ✿ Thirst
- ✿ Coating inside the vessels
- ✿ Poor functioning of *Indriya*
- ✿ Involuntary movements of the body parts, restlessness and anxiety occur frequently
- ✿ Spread of vitiated *Dosha* occurs to *Amashaya* with reddish, yellowish and pale papules, shining black, dirty, unctuous, too hot, heavy, with slow, but continuous pain, swelling, deep seated pus formation with no discharge, quick moistening. This is associated with less pain, when pressed, it bursts and give space on pressing, throws out decomposed and putrified flesh, we can observe blood vessels and ligaments and will have cadaveric smells.
- ✿ It may also be associated with destruction of consciousness and memory.
- ✿ This stage of *Visarpa* is incurable.

Granthi Visarpa¹⁷

स्थिरगुरुकठिनमधुरशीत स्निग्धान्नपानाभिद्य-
 न्दिसेविनामव्यायामादिसेविनामप्रतिकर्मशीलानां श्लेष्मा वायुश्च
 प्रकोपमापद्यते तावुभौ दुष्टप्रवृद्धी- प्रदूष्य दूष्यान् विसर्पाय कल्पेते;
 त वायुः श्लेष्मणा विवद्धमार्गस्तमेव श्लेष्माणमेकधा
 भिन्दन् क्रमेण ग्रन्थिमालां कृच्छ्रपाकसाध्यां कफा- शये संजनयति,
 उत्सन्नरक्तस्य वा प्रदूष्य रक्तं सिरास्नायुमांसत्वगाश्रितं ग्रन्थीनां मालां
 कुरुते तीव्ररुजानां स्थूलानां मणूनां वा दीर्घवृत्तरक्तानां,
 तदुपतापाज्वरातिसारका सहिष्काश्चा सशोषप्रमोह-
 वैवर्ण्यरोचकाविपाकप्र से कच्छर्दिर्मूर्च्छाङ्गभङ्गनि- द्वारतिसदनाद्याः
 प्रादुर्भवन्त्युपद्रवाः स एतैरुप- द्रुतः सर्वकर्मणां विषयमतिपतितो
 विवर्जनीयो भवतीति ग्रन्थिविसर्पः॥३१॥

Ca.Ci. - 21/39

- ✿ *Granthi Visarpa* will be manifested by the affliction of *Rakta* etc *Dhatu* by vitiated *Kapha* and *Vata Dosha*.
- ✿ Formation of multiple *Granthi* (nodular) swelling in different parts of the body which are considered to be hardly suppurating and hardly curable.
- ✿ When *Rakta* is involved, there will be formation of *Granthimala* (chain of nodular swellings). These nodular swelling are either small or large or longer or round or reddish.
- ✿ Raised body temperature

- Diarrhoea
- Cough
- Hiccup
- Breathing discomfort
- Dryness of the body parts
- Altered state of consciousness
- Discolouration of the body parts affected
- Tastelessness
- Impaired digestion
- Excess salivation
- Vomiting



Figure 127: Lakshana of Granthi Visarpa

- Altered state of consciousness either semicoma or comatose state
- Body ache
- Sleep
- Restlessness
- Sluggish movements of body parts

The stage of Granthi Visarpa is incurable.

Sannipataja Visarpa

सर्वायतनसमुत्थं सर्वलिङ्गव्यापिनं सर्वधात्वनुसारिणमाशुकारिणं
महात्ययिकमिति सन्निपातविसर्पमचिकित्स्यं विद्यात्॥४१॥

Ca.Ci. – 21/41

- Sannipataja Visarpa is manifested due to the vitiation of all three Dosha.
- This type of Visarpa is presented with the Lakshana mentioned in all Doshaja varieties of Visarpa.
- This type of Visarpa involves all Dhātu of the human body.

- This is Ashukari (producing rapid progression of the disease)
- This is treated as medical emergency. If the treatment is being given, the recovery from the illness is very remote.

Kshataja Visarpa

सद्यःक्षतव्रणमुपेत्य नरस्य पित्तं रक्तं च दोषबहुलस्य करोति शोफम्॥
स्फोटैः कुलत्थसदृशैरसितैश्च कीर्णम्॥७॥

श्यावं सलोहितमतिज्वरदाहपाकं

Su.Ni. – 10/7

- Wound caused by fresh injury
- Vitiation of Pitta and Rakta leading to the swelling
- Blackish or reddish discolouration of the swelling
- Raised body temperature
- Burning sensation
- Pus formation or suppuration
- Small blisters resemble the shape of horse gram

Sadhyasadhya of Visarpa

बहिःश्रितः श्रितश्चान्तस्तथा चोभयसंश्रितः।

विसर्पे बलमेतेषां ज्ञेयं गुरु यथोत्तरम्॥२३॥

बहिर्मांशश्रितं साध्यमसाध्यमुभयाश्रितम्।

विसर्पं दारुणं विद्यात् सुकृच्छ्रे त्वन्तराश्रयम्॥२४॥

अन्तः प्रकुपिता दोषा विसर्पस्यन्तराशनये।

बहिर्बहिः प्रकुपिताः सर्वत्रोभयसंश्रिताः॥२५॥

मममोषघातात् संमोहादयनानां विघट्टनात्।

तृष्णातियोगाद्वेगानां विषमाणां प्रवर्तनात्॥२६॥

विद्याद्विसर्पमन्तर्जमाशु चाग्निबलक्षयात्।

अतो विपर्ययाद्वाह्यमन्यैर्विद्यात् स्वलक्षणैः॥२७॥

सिध्यन्ति वातकफपित्तकृता विसर्पाः सर्वात्मकः क्षतकृतश्च न
सिद्धिमेति॥

पैत्तानिलावपि च दर्शितपूर्वलिङ्गौ सर्वे च मर्मसु भवन्ति हि
कृच्छ्रसाध्याः॥२८॥

Su. Ni. – 10/8

- If the person is diagnosed to be suffering from Visarpa manifests due to single Dosha vitiation either Vataja or Pittaja or Kaphaja¹⁸ is Sadhya (easily curable)
- Pitta and Vataja Visarpa and if Visarpa involves Marma (vital parts) is Krichrasadhya¹⁹ (difficult to cure)
- If the Visarpa is said to manifest from the vitiation of all three Dosha or is manifested in an individual due to trauma is Asadhya²⁰ (incurable)

18 Ekadoshaja type of Visarpa is usually curable because treatment is concentrating on single Dosha only

19 Marma is considered as vital point. If an injury occurs to this, this may lead to wide range of consequences ranging from pain to death. Hence, affliction of Visarpa in these regions may require meticulous treatment.

20 When all three Dosha afflicted in Visarpa, it is very difficult to cure as methodical line of treatment as per Visarpa is very difficult.

Key summary of the chapter

- ❖ विविधं सर्पति यतो विसर्पस्तेन स स्मृतः। परिसर्पोऽयच्चा नाना सर्पतः परिसर्पणात्॥1॥ Ca.Ci. – 21/11, Visarpa is the spectrum of the diseases which is associated with cardinal feature of skin lesions which spreads rapidly in the body.
This is having the involvement of Saptaka Dravya Sangraha i.e. Tridosha, Tvak, Rakta, Mamsa and Lasika.
It should be remembered that Kushtha, (skin diseases) will also have the affliction of Saptaka Dravya Sangraha. In case of Visarpa, Rakta Dhatu will be mainly afflicted during the pathologic events in the body, wherein Kushtha is mainly considered to be Tridosha dominant disease and it is slowly progressing disease when compared to Visarpa.
- ❖ **7 types of Visarpa are mentioned:** 3 single Dosha dominant, 3 dual Dosha dominant –
 - Vata and Pitta dominant (Agni Visarpa);
 - Pitta and Kapha dominant (Kardama Visarpa) and
 - Vata and Kapha dominant (Granthi Visarpa) and 1 Sannipataja Visarpa where all three Dosha affliction is seen.
- ❖ As far as Sadhyasadyata of Visarpa is concerned, if the Visarpa is present in Bahya Rogamarga, then such a type of Visarpa is considered as Sadhya (curable), if the Visarpa is present in Abhyantara Rogamarga, then such type of Visarpa is Krichrasadhyata and Visarpa present in both Bahya and Abhyantara Rogamarga, then such a type of Visarpa is Asadhyata (incurable).
- ❖ If the person is diagnosed to be suffering from Visarpa manifests due to single Dosha vitiation either Vataja or Pittaja or Kaphaja is Sadhya (easily curable); Pitta and Vataja Visarpa and if Visarpa involves Marma (vital parts) is Krichrasadhyata (difficult to cure); if the Visarpa is said to manifest from the vitiation of all three Dosha or is manifested in an individual due to trauma is Asadhyata (incurable).

Self-Assessment: Questions for Reviews

Long essay questions

- ❖ Define Visarpa, explain Nidana, Samprapti, Samprapti Ghataka, Bheda, Sadhyasadyata of Visarpa in detail

Short essay questions

- ❖ Explain Pratyatma Lakshana of Visarpa
- ❖ Describe Granthi Visarpa
- ❖ Explain Kardama Visarpa
- ❖ Explain the differences between Kushtha and Visarpa

MCQs:

1. Vata and Pitta dominance is observed in which of the following type of Visarpa?

- a. Agni Visarpa;
- b. Granthi Visarpa;
- c. Kardama Visarpa;
- d. Sannipataja Visarpa

Answer: (a)

2. Granthi Visarpa is having the dominance of

- a. Vata and Pitta;
- b. Vata and Kapha;
- c. Pitta and Kapha;
- d. Vata

Answer: (b)

3. Sankhya Samprapti of Visarpa as per Charaka is

- a. 3;
- b. 6;

- c. 7;
- d. 9

Answer: (c)

4. The differentiating factor among Saptaka Dravya Sangraha between Kushtha and Visarpa is

- a. Tvak;
- b. Rakta;
- c. Mamsa;
- d. Kapha

Answer: (b)

5. Visarpa can occur in which of the following?

- a. Only in Bahya Rogamarga;
- b. Only in Abhyantara Rogamarga;
- c. Only in Bahya and Abhyantara Rogamarga;
- d. Any of the above

Answer: (d)

Chapter resources

- ❖ <https://pharmaceutical-journal.com/article/ld/cellulitis-recognition-and-management>
- ❖ Charaka Samhita Chikitsa Sthana 21st chapter - Visarpa Chikitsa Adhyaya
- ❖ Charaka Samhita Sutra Sthana 18th chapter - Trishothiya Adhyaya
- ❖ Sushruta Samhita Sutra Sthana 17th chapter - Amapakvaishaniya Adhyaya
- ❖ Sushruta Samhita Nidana Sthana 10th chapter - Visarpa Nadi Stanaroga Nidana Adhyaya
- ❖ Textbook of pathology by Harsh Mohan, 5th edition, Jaypee brothers, New Delhi, 2005
- ❖ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar,

25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017

- ⊗ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ⊗ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
- ⊗ Best & Taylor's physiological basis of medical practice by O P Tandon and Y Tripathi, 13th edition, Wolters Kluwer Health (India) Pvt. Ltd, Gurgaon, 2012
- ⊗ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton

and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006

- ⊗ www.wikipedia.org
- ⊗ <https://emedicine.medscape.com/article/1132465-overview?form=fpf>
- ⊗ <https://www.verywellhealth.com/erysipelas-st-anthonys-fire-1068816>
- ⊗ <https://www.hopehospital.com/gangrene-types-symptoms-prevention-wet-dry-dangerous-diabetes-blood-circulation/>
- ⊗ <https://www.clinicaladvisor.com/slideshow/clinical-quiz/derm-dx-multiple-spreading-skin-lesions-in-a-vietnam-war-veteran/>
